CHAGEE

CHAGEE SINGAPORE

FORECAST THE PEAK, SHARE THE COUNTER

PREDICTIVE AND PHYSICAL AI: WHERE TO OPEN NEXT, AND WHAT THE GM DECIDES FOR THE BUSIEST HOUR

OPIM639 · GROUP 3 · KEZIAH, JIN, AYUMI, REVAN · OCTOBER 2026



Agenda

01 **Chagee in Singapore**
How it earns and sells · 01b network effects: what to grow, what to cap

02 **From farm to cup**
Where the supply chain is stable, and where it is not

03 **The data trail**
What every cup already records

04 **Our scope**
Two areas, two kinds of AI, one decision-maker

05 **Predict demand**
App searches, DBSCAN and a new-store pin

06 **Share the counter**
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07 **Split the counter**
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08 **Four scores for every location** Extension
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09 **From pin to net profit** Extension
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10 **The GM's playbook** TBC
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11 **The size of the benefit** TBC
Orders kept, revenue, and what it rests on



In Singapore, outlets run under 1 company, and every channel ends at 1 counter

One company, one data system: order and app data sit together

HOW A SINGAPORE CUP IS SOLD

GROUP NET REVENUE, FY 2025



Franchise **88%** Company-owned **12%**, growing fastest

SG Singapore outlets run under one company and one data system (Chagee source, anonymous)

In store	Walk-in (app order; tourists can order at the counter, to confirm)
Chagee app	order ahead, collect
Delivery	third-party delivery apps (e.g. Grab); no Chagee-run delivery

One counter every channel's cup is made here



44 outlets, ground-floor mall units by preference; kiosks in basements and MRT stations at entry in 2019

- **One company, one data system**
  Singapore outlets run under **1 company** and a **single data system**.
  Opportunity: A counter design or roster rule rolled out across outlets.
  Chagee source, anonymous
- **Chagee-App**
  Most orders come through the **app**, with few kiosks in store.
  Orders are recorded via app, where **searches and customer location** are logged.
  Team observation, to confirm
- **Why Chagee?**
  A **fast-growing, playful** brand with **heavy app use**.
  Likely to have **rich order data** and **room for AI** to help the stores.

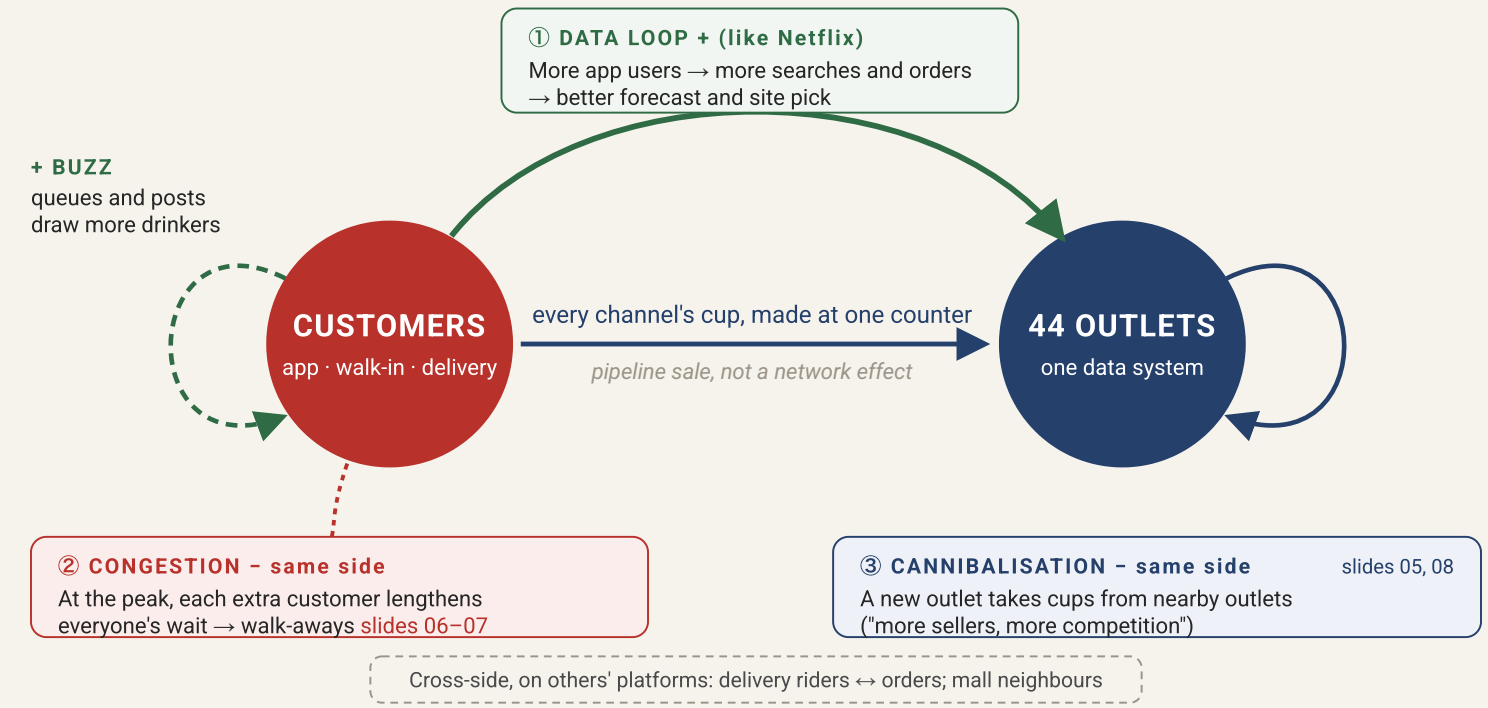
TAKEAWAY | Whatever the channel, every order ends at one counter. Peak hour is where an outlet wins or loses.

Course link · cross-side vs same-side network effects (eBay)

Chagee is not a two-sided platform; its network effects sit on one side, and our AI works on three of them

Our reading: Chagee sells its own tea, so there is no seller side to match. One data loop to grow, two crowding effects to cap.

WHERE CHAGEE SITS ON THE DIAGRAM · CLICK A LOOP



① GROW · PREDICTIVE AI

Feed the data loop

App searches pick the next site: **+731** cups a day against **+216** beside an outlet (synthetic). More users, sharper picks.

② CAP · FORECAST + COUNTER

Absorb the peak crowd

Forecast crew plus a bucket brigade: event day walk-aways **54%** → **1.2%** of peak-hour orders.

③ CAP · SITE SCORING

Count cups added, not sold

Of 837 cups at the new site, **106** (13%) move from nearby outlets. The score subtracts them.

NOT OUR LEVER

Delivery apps and malls own the cross-side effects; their riders still count in our peak.

Takeaway | More customers help Chagee only if the map and the counter can absorb them: predictive AI grows the data loop; the forecast, counter design and site score cap congestion and cannibalisation.

Supply is standard and pre-planned. Counter feels demand within minutes

Tea leaves travel one standard route. Only fresh milk and fruit are bought locally.

FOLLOW ONE CUP · STEP THROUGH



Source

Tea leaves from **Yunnan** through standard channels for every market

DATA CREATED

Shipments, lead times

Local: fresh milk, fruit

Warehouse

Separate central and regional warehouses keep storage and logistics costs down

DATA CREATED

Stock vs par, expiry

Outlet Counter

Machines: brew each cup from a scanned recipe
People: Ice, toppings and hand-over

DATA CREATED

Cups by hour

Wait times (to confirm)

Last Mile

Self-collect via app, or delivery via **third-party** apps such as Grab.
Riders wait at the same counter

DATA CREATED

Orders by channel

Rider wait (to confirm)

Customer

Orders through app and **collects** at the counter.

DATA CREATED

App orders, drop-offs

- **Stable upstream**
  Standard sourcing, regional warehouses and forecast-led restocking: Chagee already plans this part.
  YF Chuhai; Chagee Form 20-F
- **Volatile downstream**
  Demand at a counter **moves by the hour**: lunch, a mall event, rain, a new drink launch.
- **So we stop at the counter**
  Question is: How many people the counter needs this hour? And how do they work? (Not shipment)

TAKEAWAY | Chagee already plans its stock (public sources). People are deployed on local expertise, by the GM and outlet teams (Chagee source, anonymous); that is the call we model.

Orders are already recorded; the other inputs a forecast needs are candidates to confirm

Four data sources and six decisions they could feed. We follow the four that start in the app and end at the counter.

WHICH SOURCE FEEDS WHICH DECISION · STEP THROUGH

	Store and production	App and members	Delivery	Supply and context
Demand forecasts	Cups per hour by drink and channel	Member repeat demand	Orders per hour by platform	Weather, holidays, launches
Staffing and prep	Wait times, machine logs	Pickup no-shows	Hand-over peaks	Labour hours vs cups per hour
Replenishment	Drink mix per outlet	Launch trial rates	Group-order toppings	Ingredient use, expiry, par
Queue and capacity	Wait time, footfall vs sales	Store-select drop-offs	Rider wait at counter	Stock-outs at peak
Site selection	Sales density per outlet	"No store nearby", home and work	Distance and fee by postcode	Mall footfall, competitors
Menu and promos	Drink share, customisation	Trial and repeat, voucher uplift	Delivery basket mix	Collab calendar

White chips: core input; grey: refines it; red rows: our scope. Wait times, footfall, searches and location are to confirm.

- **Known and to confirm**

  Known: orders by channel and time (point of sale, app, Grab).

  To confirm: searches, customer location, wait times and walk-aways; some may need new logging.

- **The app is the link**

  Only the app ties a cup to a person. That needs consent and care under Singapore's data protection law (PDPA).

- **What we take forward**

  Demand forecast, then staffing, then queue capacity: one chain that ends with the GM's counter and roster.

TAKEAWAY | Orders by hour are recorded; searches, location, waits and walk-aways need confirming. Today, GM and outlet teams deploy people on local expertise (Chagee source, anonymous); we show how a forecast could support those calls.

New stores and the in-store peak, for one decision-maker: the GM

Two of our three ideation areas, enabled by two kinds of AI, each simulated with the trade-off the GM weighs.

FROM THREE IDEAS TO TWO · STEP THROUGH

NOT COVERED YET

Online retailing

Steer orders between app pickup and Grab by hour.

To be added. Needs platform fees and price tests we do not have.

OUR FOCUS · EXPANSION

New stores

Map where the next outlet adds the most cups, from app searches.

Rent, fit-out and payback stay future work.

Topic 3 · forecasting

OUR FOCUS · OPERATIONS

In-store operations

Forecast the peak, set the roster, share the counter.

Order data exists; the decision is daily.

Topic 3 · forecasting

Topic 5 · bucket brigades

AI · PREDICTIVE

Forecast demand: where a new outlet adds cups, and cups per hour for the roster.

AI · PHYSICAL

Automation and machines at the counter, from dispensers up to machines that make the drink.

OPERATIONS TOOLS, NOT AI

Bucket brigade and cross-training: how people share the hand steps.

The GM

General manager, Chagee Singapore

DECIDES	Where to open next, which counter steps go to machines, how many people work the peak, and how they share it
WHEN	Before a store opens, and when rosters are set
USES	The forecasts and the simulations
TODAY	People deployed on local expertise: the GM and outlet teams make the calls (Chagee source, anonymous)

SIMULATED, WITH THE TRADE-OFF THE GM WEIGHS

PREDICT	cups added vs cups moved from nearby outlets
SHARE	bucket brigade vs fixed posts
SPLIT · MACHINES	shorter wait vs higher cost
BENEFIT	orders kept vs extra labour

TAKEAWAY | Predictive AI says where to open and how many people the peak needs; physical AI changes which steps machines do; the bucket brigade decides who does the rest.

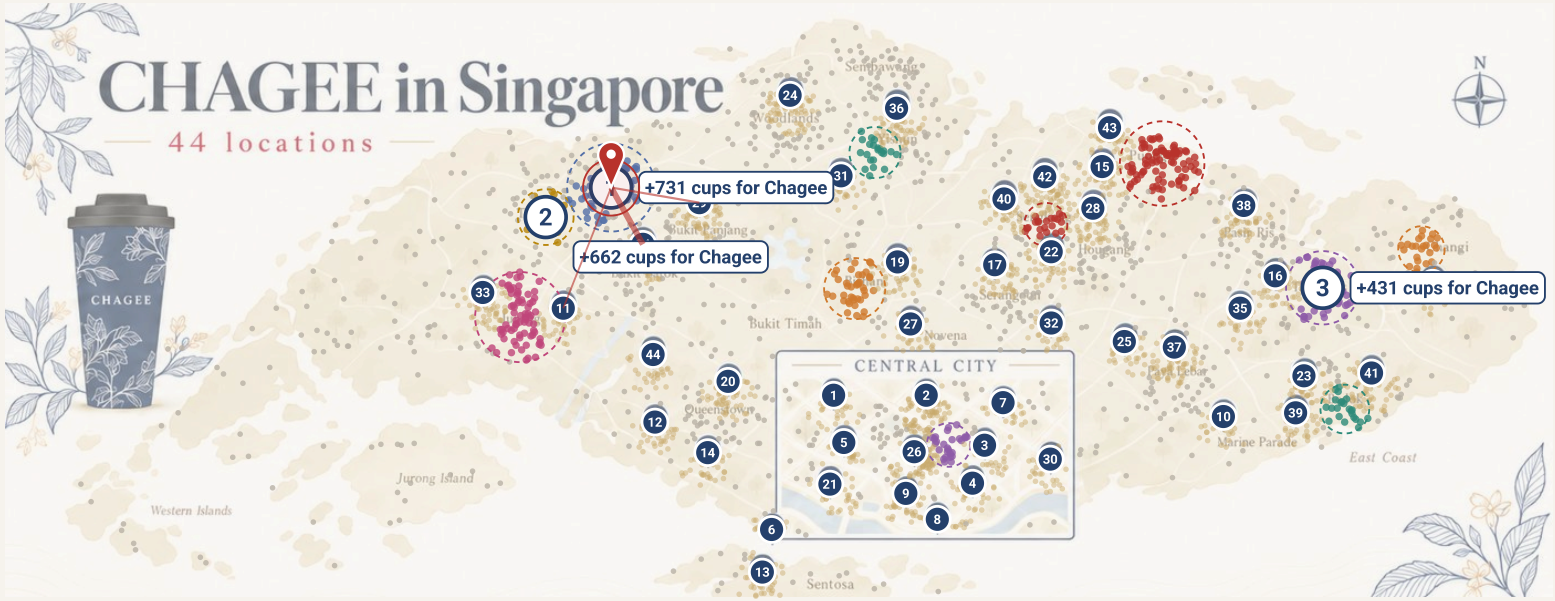
Course link · Week 3, Analytics and AI · the Flashion new-store forecast

Where would Outlet #45 add the most cups for Chagee?

Not what a new store sells, but what it adds once you subtract the cups it takes from nearby outlets.

CONTEXT Chagee is looking to expand rapidly in Singapore; how many stores it is going for is confidential.

NEW-STORE FORECAST



SUGGESTED SITE 1 · 2.7 KM FROM 34 · WEST MALL

Strong site: mostly new cups

+731 cups a day for Chagee

The new store sells 837 a day (1.5× an average outlet). 106 of those move from outlets nearby:

34 · West Mall, 2.7 km	**−77**
29 · Bukit Panjang Plaza, 3.3 km	**−28**

Peak hour 13:00: **92 cups** → **2 people** on today's counter (slides 06–07).

Synthetic app data on the team's map; outlet positions approximate (the central inset is enlarged). Not a trained model: the point is the method.

WITHOUT AI our assumed baseline

Open outlet 45 beside 34 · West Mall: it sells **604** cups a day, but 64% are moved from outlets nearby, so **+216** for Chagee.

WITH AI our proposal

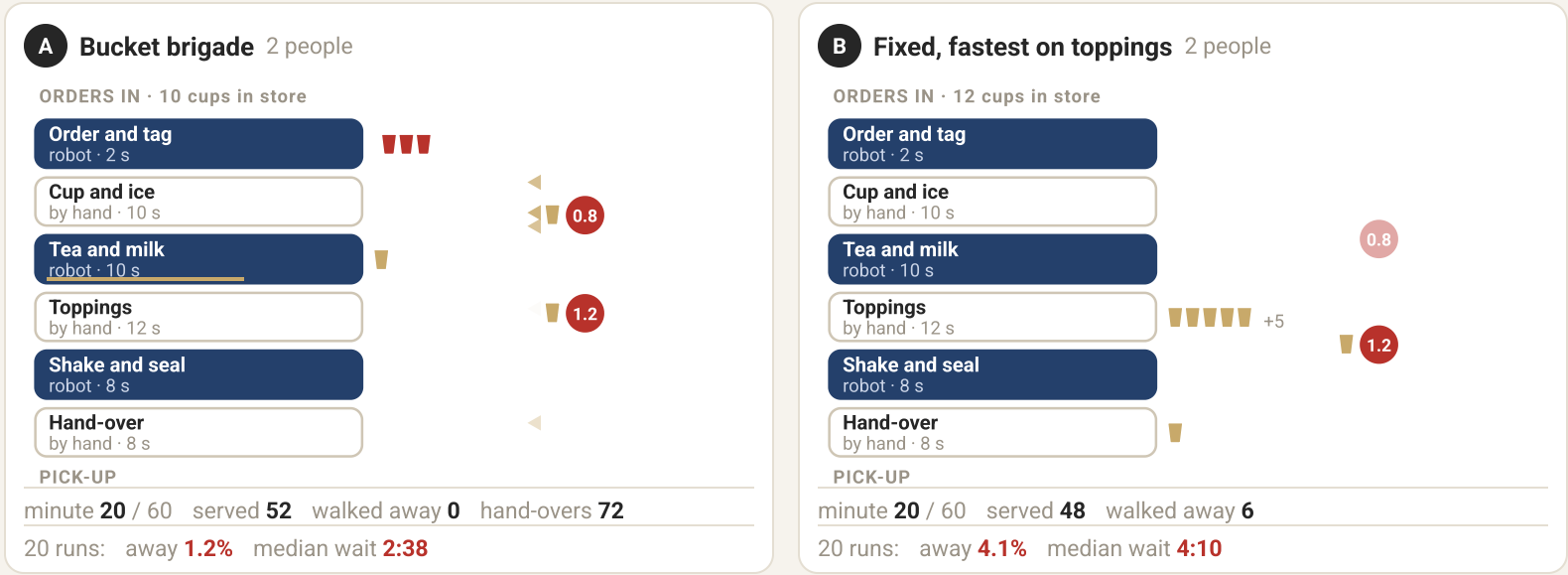
DBSCAN clusters synthetic app searches; the assumed demand model scores the same outlet 2.7 km away, near Choa Chu Kang: sells 837, **+731** for Chagee.

Course link · Week 5 and Week 6, equipment and technology · the bucket-brigade simulation

With a lean roster, a bucket brigade keeps cups moving without knowing who is fastest

Today's split (our scenario), two ways of sharing the hand steps, side by side. Pick what each side runs.

PEAK HOUR · SAME CUSTOMERS ON BOTH SIDES



Red circle = a person (number = speed) · gold ring = held back · faded = walking · ▲ = hand-over · navy = robot · red cup = waiting for a person

ALL THREE RULES, MEAN OF 20 RUNS

EVENT DAY, 2 PEOPLE	WALKED AWAY	MEDIAN WAIT
Bucket brigade	**1.2%**	**2:38**
Fixed, fastest on toppings	4.1%	4:10
Fixed, slowest on toppings	34.9%	9:47

At the people on side A. A customer leaves if the wait would pass 5 min. With spare people, a well-assigned fixed line is as good or a little faster.

- **Why lean is where it counts**
  Work flows to whoever is free, so the line balances itself (Topic 5). Fixed stations are only as good as the guess of who is fast.

ASSUMED BASELINE *illustrative*

A normal-day roster (1 at the peak) on an event day: **54%** of peak-hour orders walk away.

PROPOSED SCENARIO *in our model*

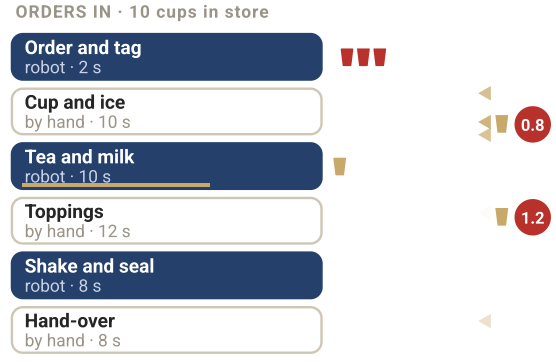
The forecast sets the crew (2) and a bucket brigade shares it: **1.2%** walk away, without knowing who is fastest.

Course link · Week 5 and Week 6, equipment and technology

In our model, one tea-and-milk machine is the cheapest on every day type Pilot this against today's split.

PEAK HOUR · SAME CUSTOMERS

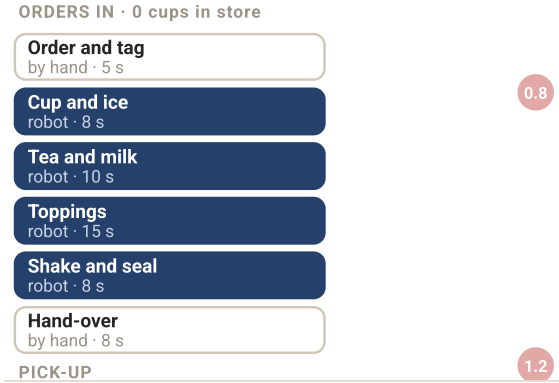
A Today's split (our scenario) 2 people, brigade



minute **20** / 60 served **52** walked away **0** hand-overs **72**

20 runs: away **1.2%** wait **2:38** **S$402**/day

B Machine-made drink (scenario) 2 people, fixed posts



minute **20** / 60 served **57** walked away **0**

20 runs: away **0.0%** wait **1:06** **S$465**/day

Navy = robot, white = by hand (click to switch) · red circle = a person · faded = walking · red cup = waiting for a person.

FIVE OPTIONS, MEAN OF 20 RUNS

EVENT DAY	PEOPLE	WALKED AWAY	WAIT	COST/DAY
Today's split (our scenario)	2	1.2%	2:38	S$402
Machine-made drink (scenario)	2 fixed	0.0%	1:06	S$465
All by hand	4	0.0%	1:25	S$422
All robots	–	0.0%	0:58	S$562
One machine (tea and milk) ✓	**3**	**0.2%**	**1:44**	**S$335**

✓ cheapest within the limit · fastest: All robots

Normal day, cost a day: One machine (tea and milk) S$305 (cheapest) · All by hand S$361 · Today's split (our scenario) S$372 · Machine-made drink (scenario) S$435 · All robots S$562.

ASSUMED BASELINE
illustrative

All by hand on an event day: **4 people**, median wait 1:24, **S$422** a day.

PROPOSED SCENARIO
in our model

In our model, one tea-and-milk machine on an event day: **3 people**, **S$335** a day, wait 1:44; today's split (our scenario) S$402, wait 2:38.

GM DECISION

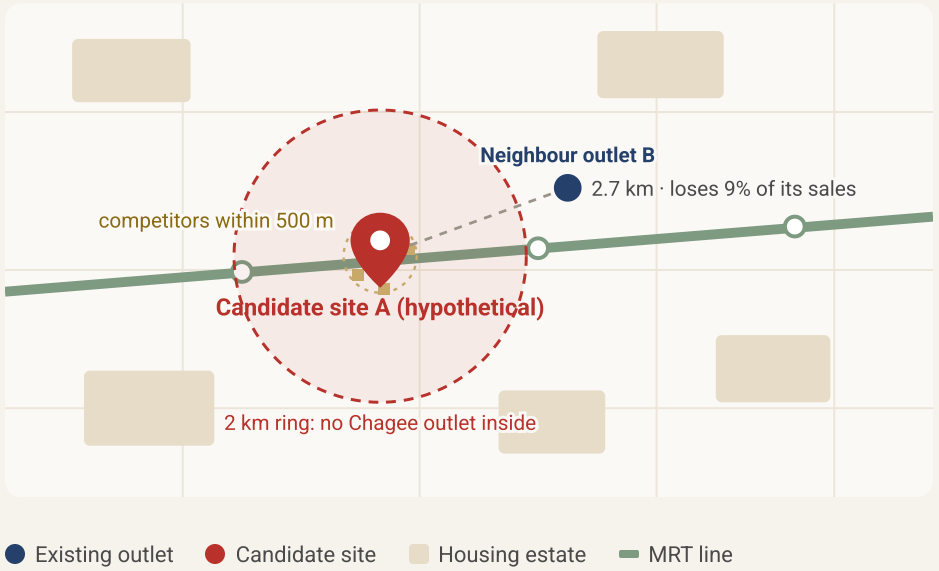
Pilot one tea-and-milk machine against today's split (our scenario): in our model S$305–335 a day against S$372–402. That holds only while a machine unit costs more than about S$905 a month (same rate for its 1 unit and the split's 3; wage, volume and crews held fixed). We assume S$1,909; Chagee's real cost is unknown.

Extension: where this scales next. Not included in the S$ benefit.

Four scores for every location

Corporate drops a pin; the model rates it on four things (illustrative). Decision-maker here: corporate expansion planning, not the GM.

SCHEMATIC MAP · HYPOTHETICAL PINS



Demand score HAND-SET
Residents, workers and transit riders within reach, plus footfall. **84**

Delivery demand score HAND-SET
Orders from the area on third-party delivery apps.
All Chagee delivery goes through third-party apps (anonymous Chagee source, to confirm), so we use area demand, not "served from a farther outlet". Whether the platforms share this data is to confirm. **78**

Competition score HAND-SET
Bubble-tea and cafe outlets within 500 m; dense competition lowers the score, a few prove demand. **61**

Cannibalisation factor COMPUTED · SLIDE 05 ENGINE
Site A: 13% of its cups would move from existing Chagee outlets; neighbour outlet B loses 9%. Deducted so the result is net to Chagee. **−13**

Site score WEIGHTED
Demand 50%, delivery 20%, competition 30% (hand-set weights). **76**

ATTRIBUTES THE MODEL TAGS TO EACH PIN residents and workers within 1 km · MRT and bus tap-ins · footfall · delivery orders from the area · competing outlets within 500 m · Chagee outlets within 2 km · rent per sq ft · staff needed at peak

WHAT IS AI HERE Scoring a pin from its attributes would be a supervised model trained on outlets' results: a production idea. Here the three scores are set by hand, and the cannibalisation factor is computed by the slide 05 engine on synthetic data.

Illustrative. Synthetic data, not Chagee data. Chagee's opening history is internal and we do not have it.

Extension: where this scales next. Not included in the S$ benefit.

From pin to net profit

Six steps from a pin to a go / no-go, on profit net to Chagee overall (illustrative). Decision-maker here: corporate expansion planning, not the GM.

1 Pin a location
Corporate clicks a point on the map.
NOT AI

2 Tag attributes
People, transit, footfall, delivery, competitors, outlets nearby, rent.
DATA

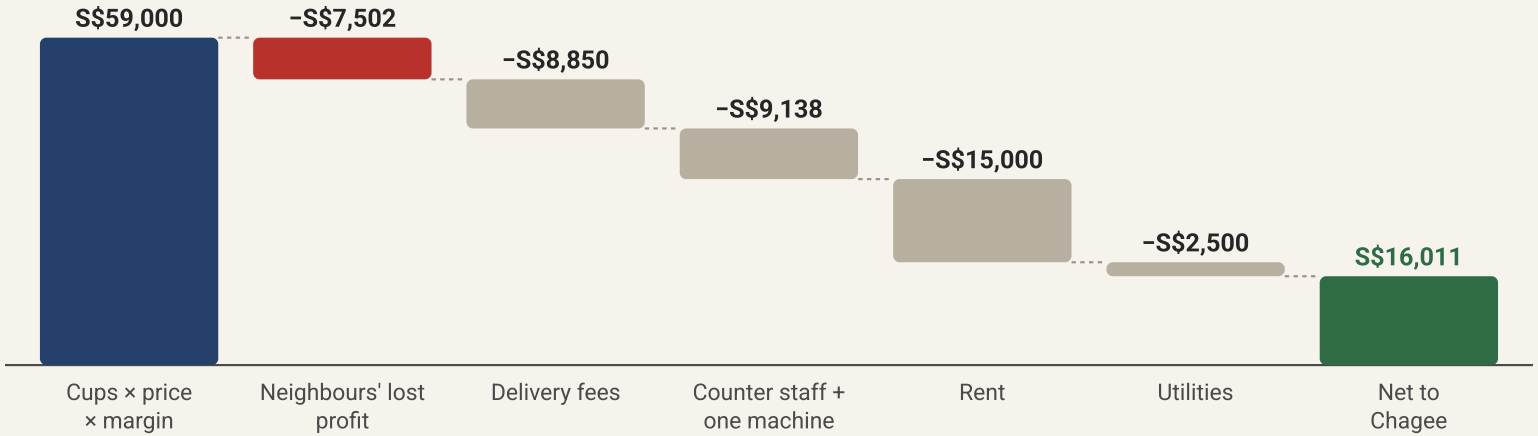
3 Four scores
Demand, delivery, competition, cannibalisation (slide 08).
AI · SUPERVISED MODEL

4 Find look-alikes
Anonymised outlets (Outlet 12, Outlet 27): their cups a day, what neighbours lost.
AI · SIMILARITY SEARCH

5 Forecast net profit
Cups a day, running cost, minus the profit neighbours lose.
COMPUTED BELOW

6 Decide
Open, pilot or skip. Actuals feed back: continual learning.
AI · CONTINUAL LEARNING

NET PROFIT TO CHAGEE, A MONTH · SITE A, TOP APP-SEARCH CLUSTER



At 278–833 cups a day: **−S$3,506** to **S$34,624** a month. Neighbour outlet B, 2.7 km away, loses 9% of its sales. Delivery fees: 30% of cups × 30% commission. Counter: the one-machine setup, normal-day roster (counter model).

STEP 6 · RECOMMENDATION

Pilot

positive at 556 cups a day, negative at 278, the low end: test it before a full lease.

Site score **76 / 100 (slide 08)**
Payback **≈ 25 months on S$400,000**

A strong-demand site can still fail if rent or staffing is too high, or if it mostly takes sales from our own neighbours.

In practice this needs Chagee's opening history. With about 44 outlets in Singapore the model must stay simple (few attributes, ranges not point values).

Illustrative. Synthetic data, not Chagee data. Chagee's opening history is internal and we do not have it. Cups a day, price and margin are the benefit slide's (slide 11); rent, delivery, utilities and set-up cost are assumptions, not Chagee data.

 TBC · DRAFT, TO BE CONFIRMED

Four decisions for the GM, each from a simulation, then a pilot to test them

	DECISION	WHY, FROM THE MODEL	REVISIT WHEN
1 **Where to open** slide 05 · DBSCAN + assumed demand model	**Open where app searches cluster, not beside an existing outlet.**	**+731** against **+216** cups a day for the same new outlet. Synthetic app-search data: this shows the method, not a finding about real outlets.	Rerun on Chagee's app logs, if searches and location are recorded, before any lease.
2 **What to automate** slide 07 · physical AI	**In our model, one tea-and-milk machine is the cheapest on every day type; pilot it against today's split (our scenario).**	**S$305–335** a day against S$372–402. The two cost the same at about **S$905 a month per machine unit** (1 unit against 3), with wage, volume, station speeds and crews held fixed; we assume S$1,909. Amacha's S$10,000 is a one-off price; without machine life, upkeep and financing we cannot turn it into a monthly cost.	When Chagee's real machine cost is known.
3 **How many people** slides 06, 11 · forecast + economic rule	**Economic rule: add a person on event days, not on busy days.**	With the one machine: peak crew 2 → **3** on event days; 2 on busy days, where an extra person costs more than the orders it keeps.	When the forecast peak moves.
4 **How to share** slide 06 · operations	**Test a bucket brigade against fixed posts for the hand steps.**	In the recommended setup (one machine, 3 people, event day): **0.2%** walk away with a brigade, 0.4% with well-assigned fixed posts, 22% with badly assigned ones; median wait 1:44 against 2:18.	Fixed posts once there is spare staff.

- **Pilot in 3 outlets**

Shadow	Roster	Machine
forecast only	economic rule	one vs today's split

KPIs: cups per labour hour, wait time and walk-aways at the peak. Compare forecast and actual cups weekly.

- **Limits we know**

All figures are illustrative assumptions, not Chagee data. Machine costs and speeds are assumed; breakdowns and breaks are not modelled.

- **To confirm with Chagee**

The real machine cost per unit, whether outlets log wait times and walk-aways, and how today's local staffing calls compare with the forecast.

ASSUMED BASELINE illustrative — One machine and a flat crew of 2 every day: **23%** of event-day peak orders walk away.

PROPOSED SCENARIO in our model — The forecast and the economic rule add a person on event days only (2 → 3): **0.2%** walk away; busy days stay at 2 (0.1%).

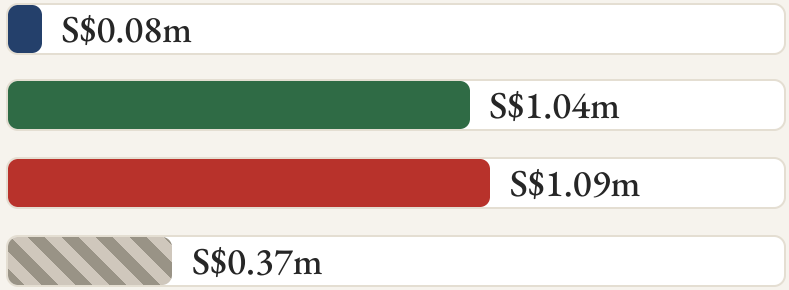
 TBC · DRAFT, TO BE CONFIRMED

In our model, about S$1.09m a year across 44 outlets against an illustrative baseline, almost all from one machine's labour saving

Modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions, not demonstrated savings and not savings against Chagee's actual operations, where the GM and teams staff on local expertise. The pilot compares one machine with today's split (our scenario).

PROFIT A YEAR, ALL 44 OUTLETS · ECONOMIC RULE THROUGHOUT

AGAINST THE ILLUSTRATIVE ALL-HAND BASELINE (FLAT NORMAL-DAY ROSTER)



PILOT COMPARISON: THE PROPOSED SCENARIO AGAINST TODAY'S SPLIT (OUR SCENARIO), BOTH ON THE ECONOMIC RULE



Profit = orders kept × price × margin, plus labour saved, minus machine cost. Calendar: 104 busy days (weekends) and 11 event days (public holidays) a year, an illustrative definition. Baseline: all by hand, the normal-day crew every day. Peak hour only, so orders kept are a floor. Every figure, range and both crew rules: appendix.

PHYSICAL AI · ONE TEA-AND-MILK MACHINE

Most of the benefit: labour

Lets the roster drop from 2 people to 1 in the off-peak hours: **S$1.04m** a year after the machine's cost.

FORECAST + ECONOMIC RULE

Adds event-day orders on top of the machine

Adds a person on event days only (2 → 3), keeping about 35 more orders per outlet that day: 390 a year, **S$0.05m** across Singapore. On its own, all by hand: S$0.08m.

READ WITH CARE

The big number rests on one assumption

The minimum crew, 2 by hand and 1 with machines, is ours. Without it, S$1.09m falls to **S$0.37m**. The pilot arm beats today's split by S$1.22m: more than the headline, because today's split is itself S$0.14m below the baseline.

ASSUMED BASELINE *illustrative*

Flat normal-day roster, all by hand: about **1,291** peak-hour orders a year walk away per outlet.

PROPOSED SCENARIO *in our model*

Both levers, one run: **1,278** kept a year per outlet, profit **S$1.09m** across 44 outlets (S$0.37m without the minimum-crew rule).

THANK YOU

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

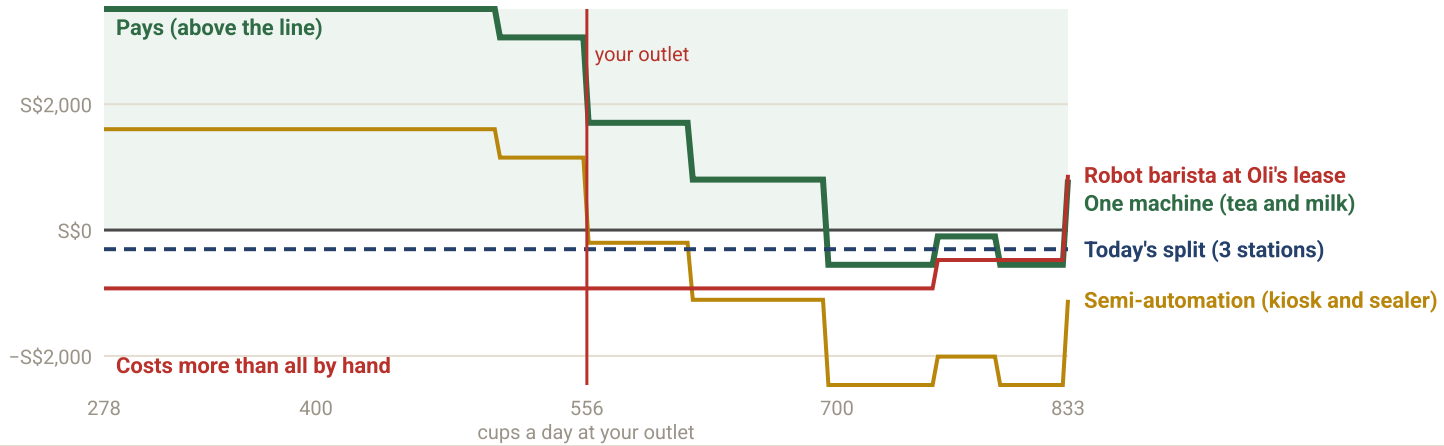
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A machine pays only when it removes a person-shift for less than the shift costs

To our knowledge, based on public sources; vendor list prices, not cost to implement. Chagee's equipment cost is not public; its Singapore relaunch used semi-automated equipment (Vulcan Post).

NET GAIN A MONTH AGAINST ALL BY HAND · ONE OUTLET



Shown at 556 cups a day, wage S$15.06 an hour, S$1,909 a month per machine unit (sliders on screen).

	1 Semi-automation	2 Beverage platform	3 Milk-tea machine	4 Robot arm	5 Robot barista
	Gong Cha Singapore	Gong cha Super Wu	Amacha, one shop	Richtech ADAM	Oli; coffee-first
	Not disclosed	*Not disclosed*	S$10,000 to buy	*Not disclosed, rental only*	US$4,990/mo lease
	PRESS	COMPANY CLAIM	PRESS	VENDOR PAGE	VENDOR PAGE

The model's S$1,909 a month is per station unit (our reading: a semi-automated station). Semi-automation and the beverage platform are priced at it because their real prices are not disclosed; robot prices are per setup. Full table and sources in the appendix.

START HERE

One machine on the tea and milk

+S$1,706 a month vs all by hand

Saves 8 person-hours a day (S$3,614 a month) for one S$1,909 unit. Simple payback, if it lets the roster drop one person-shift: 2.8 months on Amacha's S$10,000.

WATCH

Today's 3-station split

−S$305 a month vs all by hand

Saves 12 person-hours a day (S$5,422) but pays for 3 units (S$5,726).

WAIT FOR VOLUME

Robots: arm or barista

757+ cups a day before they save more labour than today's split (labour only, not a cost break-even)

At 556 cups, Oli's lease (S$6,350) is S$928 a month worse; a robot setup would need to cost under S$5,422 a month. The arm's price is not disclosed.

Model assumption that drives all three: minimum crew 2 by hand, 1 with machines, off-peak. Station speeds are the model's, not vendor claims. Rosters step in whole people, so results flip with volume and wage.

WITHOUT AI
our assumed baseline

All by hand at 556 cups a day: **24 person-hours** a day, **S$10,843** a month of labour.

WITH AI
our proposal

One tea-and-milk machine: **16 person-hours** a day, **+S$1,706** a month after its unit cost. A robot setup (four stations on machines) starts to save more labour than today's split at about 757 cups a day; labour only, not a cost break-even.

Per outlet, about 61 orders kept on an event day and 5 on a busy day; on an illustrative calendar, S$7,539 of revenue a year

Modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions, not demonstrated savings, against an illustrative baseline, not Chagee's operations. Economic rule for the headline figures. Peak hour only; conservative. Prices to our knowledge, based on public sources.

Profit a year, 44 outlets: **S$1.09m** = counter automation, physical AI **S$1.04m** (depends on the minimum-crew rule) + forecast roster, predictive AI **S$0.05m** | Without / with the minimum-crew rule: **S$0.37m to S$1.09m**

ONE OUTLET AT 556 CUPS A DAY · BOTH LEVERS, ONE RUN

EVENT DAY
61 orders kept
Revenue S$358 (× S$5.90) · profit S$241
Counter: labour saved − machine S$27

BUSY DAY
5.4 orders kept
Revenue S$32 (× S$5.90) · profit S$76
Counter: labour saved − machine S$57

NORMAL DAY
0.2 orders kept
Revenue S$1 (× S$5.90) · profit S$58
Counter: labour saved − machine S$57

A YEAR	PER OUTLET	44 OUTLETS, IF ALL LOOKED LIKE THIS MODEL
Orders kept peak hour, busy and event days	**1,278** range −121 to 1,452	**56,221**
Revenue orders × price	**S$7,539** range −S$832 to S$10,015	**S$331,704**
Profit margin 50%–70%: −S$754 to +S$754	S$24,660	S$1,085,027
Labour saving, counter labour saved − machine cost; shown on its own	S$20,136	S$886,005

Revenue and labour are never added: revenue is orders × price; profit is orders × price × margin, plus labour saved, minus machine cost.

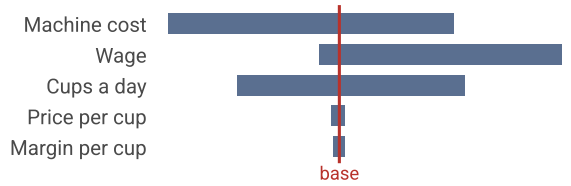
Calendar: 104 busy days (weekend days) and 11 event days (Singapore public holidays) a year: an illustrative definition, to confirm with Chagee; sliders on screen.

ORDERS · PROFIT A YEAR	WALK-AWAY RULE	ECONOMIC RULE
Forecast crew	1,242 · S$603	670 · S$1,711
Machine	888 · S$23,611	888 · S$23,611
Both, one run	**1,278 · S$24,660**	**1,278 · S$24,660**
Both, today's split counter −S$305/month	1,124 · −S$3,142	1,124 · −S$3,142

Walk-away rule: fewest people keeping peak-hour walk-aways within 2% (the forecast crew at 556 cups a day). Economic rule: add a person only when orders kept × price × margin beat the extra labour. "Both" is one run, not a sum: the levers keep many of the same orders, and with the machine the forecast crew needs fewer extra hours (−S$662 profit against the sum). Headline figures use the economic rule.

Against what
A flat normal-day roster and an all-by-hand counter. Chagee deploys people on local expertise (Chagee source, anonymous), so this baseline is ours, not Chagee's.

All inputs at their worst/best end together
Profit a year, one outlet: low **−S$15,660** · base **S$24,660** · high **S$101,166**



Fragile: the minimum crew
The counter lever rests on the model's minimum crew off-peak: 2 by hand, 1 with machines. Profit a year per outlet: S$24,660 with it; S$8,395 with 1 either way.

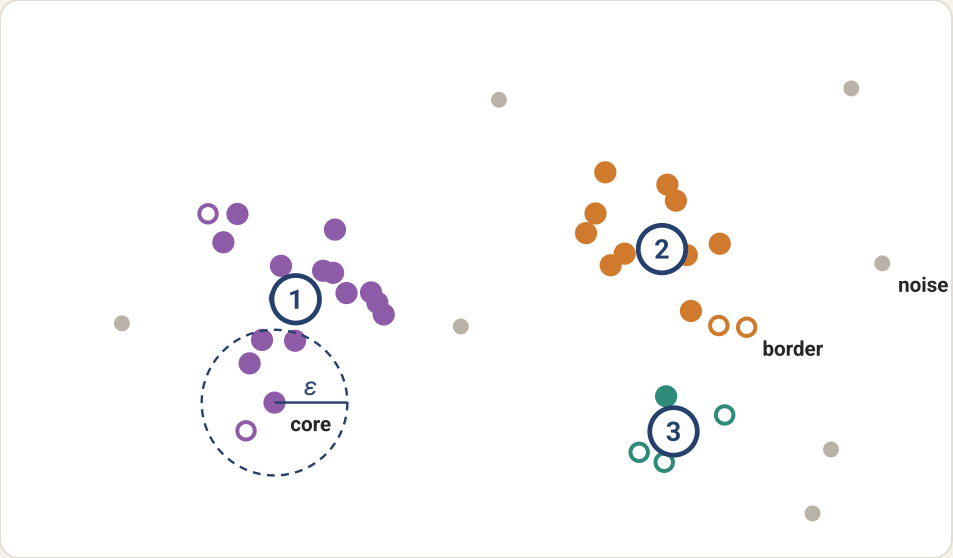
Not sized
Delivery levers (third-party; channel margins not disclosed), membership and CRM, waste (no inventory model in this deck), and the new-store site forecast (shown as cups added only).

ASSUMED BASELINE illustrative
Flat normal-day roster, all by hand: about **1,291** peak-hour orders a year walk away per outlet.

PROPOSED SCENARIO in our model
Both levers, one run: **1,278** kept a year per outlet, profit **S$1.09m** across 44 outlets (S$0.37m without the minimum-crew rule).

DBSCAN finds where searches bunch up; a proximity model turns a pin into cups

DBSCAN IN FOUR MOVES · TOY EXAMPLE



1. **Radius ε.** Two searches are neighbours if they are within ε of each other (the cluster-radius slider).
2. **Core.** A search with at least the minimum number of searches within ε (counting itself) is a core point.
3. **Grow.** A cluster spreads from core to core. Searches it reaches that are not core join as border points.
4. **Noise.** Searches no cluster reaches. Unlike k-means, nobody picks the number of clusters, and odd shapes are fine.

Unsupervised: no labels or past openings are needed. Ester, Kriegel, Sander and Xu (1996). On slide 05 it runs only on searches with no outlet within walking distance; each cluster's centre is a candidate site.

THE SIMULATED NUMBERS, IN ORDER · AT THE SLIDER DEFAULTS

1	**App searches**	Synthetic dots on land: 15% spread evenly, 35% around the outlets' malls, the rest around 20 towns	**3,000 dots**
2	**No store nearby**	The nearest outlet is further than the walking distance	**1 km · 46% of dots**
3	**DBSCAN**	Clusters the no-store-nearby dots	**ε 0.6 km · min 15 · 11 clusters**
4	**Pull of a store**	Fades with distance d: exp(−½ (d/L)²), with the length L set by the walking distance	**L = 1 km**
5	**Who buys where**	A dot buys at a store in proportion to its pull, against the pull of not buying (a store next door = one)	**not buying 0.3**
6	**Calibration**	Each dot's weight is set so the average outlet sells the deck's cups a day (cups a year ÷ open days)	**556 cups a day**
7	**Score a pin**	Cups for Chagee = what the new store sells − what it moves from nearby outlets	**top: 837 − 106 = +731**
8	**Verdict**	Share of the new store's cups that are new to Chagee	**strong ≥ 60% · weak < 40%**
9	**Opening roster**	Peak-hour cups ÷ cups one person handles, with the safety margin	**one per 83 cups**

All synthetic: the dots, towns and weights are assumptions on the team's map (not to scale), not Chagee app logs or population data. With real app logs, steps one and two change; the rest runs unchanged.

Every rung, every price as published, and where it comes from

To our knowledge, based on public sources. Physical AI: automation and machines. A gap is "not disclosed", never a guess.

RUNG	EXAMPLE	AUTOMATES · STEPS ON MACHINES (OUR MAPPING)	VENDOR LIST PRICE	CLAIMS (NOT MODEL INPUTS)	RELIABILITY	SOURCE
1 **Semi-automation**	Gong Cha Singapore	Sugar dispensers, cup sealers, self-order kiosks. **Order and tag, Shake and seal**. Kiosk = order and tag, sealer = shake and seal. Sugar dispensing sits inside tea and milk, so it is not modelled.	*Not disclosed*	Over 20% productivity from self-ordering; 5% manpower saving (no baseline given)	PRESS	https://www.ntuc.org.sg/uportal/news/Technology-Brewing-Up-the-Bubble-Tea-Business/
2 **Beverage platform**	Gong cha Super Wu (Feb 2026)	Dispenses tea, sweeteners and syrups; brewing and shaking stay manual. **Tea and milk**	*Not disclosed*	Up to 65% higher peak productivity	COMPANY CLAIM	https://marketech-apac.com/gong-cha-launches-gong-cha-2-0-to-modernise-global-operations-and-store-design/
3 **Single automated milk-tea machine**	Amacha (one small shop, owner interview)	Makes the milk tea itself. **Tea and milk**	S$10,000 to buy	The shop's total opening cost was S$209,000 (not a machine cost)	PRESS	https://www.malaymail.com/news/life/2026/10/05/opening-a-milk-tea-shop-in-singapore-can-rack-up-to-s209000-even-before-the-first-cup-is-poured/237715
–	**Our scenario: today's split**	**Order and tag, Tea and milk, Shake and seal**. A scenario of ours (slides 06 and 07), not Chagee's disclosed setup	Model: S$1,909 a month per station unit		OUR ASSUMPTION	assumptions.json
4 **Robot arm that makes boba**	Richtech ADAM	Cup, ice, tea, toppings and sealing by one robot arm. **Cup and ice, Tea and milk, Toppings, Shake and seal**	*Not disclosed*. Rental only; price not published	–	VENDOR PAGE	https://richtechrobotics.com/solutions/adam
5 **Robot barista**	Oli	A whole drink station in one unit. **Cup and ice, Tea and milk, Toppings, Shake and seal**. Coffee-first. No tea drinks listed for Oli or Artly.	US$59,000 (≈ S$75,078) to buy; US$4,990 (≈ S$6,350) a month lease	–	VENDOR PAGE	https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista
	Artly		US$68,000–88,000 (≈ S$86,530–111,980) to buy; US$2,500–4,000 (≈ S$3,181–5,090) a month lease; US$2,500–4,000 a month software Oli's estimate of a competitor. The figures as given do not say whether the lease replaces or adds to the purchase, so no verdict is computed.	–	VENDOR PAGE	https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista
	Cafe X		US$250,000 (≈ S$318,125) to buy Oli's estimate of a competitor's price.	–	VENDOR PAGE	https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista
–	**Chagee Singapore**	Chagee's own equipment cost is not public. Its Singapore relaunch used semi-automated equipment.	*Not public*	–	PRESS	https://vulcanpost.com/872176/chagee-singapore-comeback-after-sudden-exit/

Vendor list prices, not cost to implement: installation, training, maintenance, power, space and import are not included; USD converts at S$1.2725 per US$. **Simple payback** = list price ÷ labour saved a month, with no maintenance or financing. **The model's S$1,909 a month** is per station unit: our reading: one semi-automated station unit (for example a dispenser or a cup sealer), amortised with upkeep. Not a robot barista lease; robot prices in machine_tiers.json are per setup. **Vendor speed and throughput claims** are listed, never used: every rung runs at the model's station speeds. **Steps on machines** is our mapping. Artly and Cafe X prices are Oli's estimates of competitors.

Where every number comes from

FACTS QUOTED

Outlets in Singapore: 44. Store count used on the storyboard deck. The doc also cites 46 (VnExpress, earlier); the later directory count is used. *[L-sg-directory]*

Franchise share of FY2025 net revenue: 0.88. Secondary source; flagged wherever shown. *[L-koalagains]*

Company-owned share of FY2025 net revenue: 0.12. Secondary source; flagged wherever shown. *[L-koalagains]*

SOURCES

L-sg-directory Chagee Singapore store directory, mapped by the team (44 locations, checked 15 Oct 2026); Mothership, Sep 2026, https://mothership.sg/2026/09/chagee-more-heartland-stores-singapore-eugene-lee/ gives the same count. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

L-koalagains KoalaGains, 'CHA business and moat', https://koalagains.com/stocks/NASDAQ/CHA/business-and-moat (SECONDARY - flag when used): FY2025 net revenue about 88% from the franchise (master franchise) model and about 12% from company-owned stores, the latter growing fastest. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

L-yfchuhai YF Chuhai, https://www.yfchuhai.com/article/9751.html: Chagee's leaf supply chain is in China; it sources only two ingredients locally, fresh milk and fruit. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

L-sec20f Chagee Holdings Form 20-F for FY2025, SEC EDGAR, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2013649/000110465926050766/cha-20251231x20f.htm: separate centralized and regional warehouses to lower storage and logistics costs. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

L-unsw UNSW BusinessThink, Oct 2024: Chagee semi-automation, baristas scan a QR code and the machine dispenses the formulation. (brief.md section 9)

I-chagee-contact CHAGEE SOURCE, ANONYMOUS (Oct 2026): a Chagee source who asked not to be named; do not identify them. Four points only: whether Singapore outlets are owned, a joint venture or franchised does not matter for this work, because the data sits in one system; Singapore outlets run under one company and one data system; all delivery is via third-party apps; people are deployed on local expertise: the GM and outlet teams make the staffing calls.

I-sg-groundfloor INFORMAL - quote in the team's ideation doc (Chagee Singapore's Lee: 'Whenever you see a Chagee, it's always on the first floor'; kiosk-style outlets in basements and MRT stations at entry in 2019). The article is not named in the doc; confirm the source before quoting.

I-team-app-first INFORMAL - team observation in the ideation doc: Chagee Singapore sells mainly through its app, with minimal order kiosks in outlets. Confirm before citing.

L-ester1996 Ester, M., Kriegel, H.-P., Sander, J. and Xu, X. (1996). A density-based algorithm for discovering clusters in large spatial databases with noise. Proceedings of the Second International Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD-96), 226-231. The DBSCAN algorithm used on slide 05.

P-honeycombers PRESS - in-store sightings, indicative. Honeycombers (Feb 2026), https://thehoneycombers.com/singapore/china-bubble-tea-brand-singapore/ : Chagee price sightings in Singapore; not a current full menu.

P-eatbook PRESS - in-store sightings, indicative. Eatbook (Aug 2024), https://eatbook.sg/?p=168476 : Chagee price sightings in Singapore; not a current full menu, and older than the deck.

I-team-expansion INFORMAL - team research (Oct 2026): Chagee is looking to expand rapidly in Singapore; how many stores it is going for is confidential. Singapore only. Confirm before citing.

I-team-site-framework TEAM WORK (Oct 2026): Jin's site-selection framework, two team slides ('Four Scores for Every Location', 'From Pin to Profit Forecast'): four scores per pin, six steps from a pin to a go / no-go on profit net to Chagee. Used for slides 08 and 09 (extension). Its example values and outlet names are not used; ours are illustrative.

ASSUMPTIONS (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON, ILLUSTRATIVE)

Cups per outlet per year: 200000 cups/store/year

Share of the day's cups in each open hour: 0.04, 0.06, 0.1, 0.11, 0.08, 0.08, 0.09, 0.1, 0.1, 0.09, 0.08, 0.07 share of daily cups per open hour (10:00 to 22:00), sums to 1

Busy and event day multipliers: none 1, moderate 1.5, large 2.5 x forecast arrival rate

Busiest hours the multiplier lands on: 2 busiest forecast hours that get the surge

Seconds per cup by hand, per station: ticket 5, cup ice 10, tea milk 15, topping finish 12, shake seal 10, handover 8 seconds of one average worker per cup

Seconds per cup by robot, per station: ticket 2, cup ice 8, tea milk 10, topping finish 15, shake seal 8, handover 6 seconds per cup per machine unit

Stations the robots do today: ticket, tea milk, shake seal

Spread of worker speeds: 0.2 +/- share around average speed

Minute-to-minute variation in pace: 0.25 coefficient of variation, minute to minute

Share of new staff: 0.25 share of roster in first months

New staff speed: 0.7 x average speed

Coordination loss, people around robots: 0.9 multiplier on human-pool throughput in the mixed setup

Minimum people on the counter: all human 2, mixed 1, all machine 0 workers per open hour

Roster safety margin over the forecast: 1.2 x forecast peak rate

Labour cost per hour worked (SGD): 15.06 SGD per hour worked, fully loaded (statutory costs)

Walk-away limit for the GM's split table: 0.02 share of peak-hour orders that walk away

Synthetic app-intent dots (slide 05): 3000 synthetic app-intent dots on the map

Walking distance to collect: 1 km a customer will walk to collect

Distance decay, share of the walking distance: 1 distance decay length as a share of walk_km

Pull of not buying: 0.3 pull of not buying, against a store next door (= 1)

DBSCAN cluster radius: 0.6 km

DBSCAN minimum searches: 15 dots within eps to form a cluster core

Map scale: 0.033 km per map pixel

Wait at which a customer walks away: 5 minutes

Price per cup, in store (slides 09, 11): 5.9 SGD per cup, in store

Margin per cup, share of price (slides 09, 11): 0.6 share of price (contribution per avoided order: price minus ingredients and packaging)

Busy days a year (slide 11, illustrative): 104 busy days a year (day type 'moderate')

Event days a year (slide 11, illustrative): 11 event days a year (day type 'large')

Walking-back speed (Week 5 units): 6 lines per hour

Site scores, hand-set (slides 08, 09, illustrative): demand 84, delivery 78, competition 61 score out of 100

Site score weights (slide 09, illustrative): demand 0.5, delivery 0.2, competition 0.3 weight in the site score, sums to 1

Rent per outlet per month (slide 09, assumption, not Chagee data): 15000 SGD per outlet per month

Utilities per outlet per month (slide 09, assumption): 2500 SGD per outlet per month

Share of cups via delivery apps (slide 09, assumption): 0.3 share of the outlet's cups sold through third-party delivery apps

Delivery platform commission (slide 09, assumption): 0.3 share of a delivery order's price paid to the platform

Set-up cost per new outlet (slide 09, assumption, not Chagee data): 400000 SGD per new outlet, one-off (fit-out, equipment, deposits, opening)

CLAIMS WE DID NOT MAKE

No Chagee sales, staffing or wait-time data is used; the forecast is not a trained model. We do not claim the bucket brigade always beats fixed stations: with spare staff, a well-assigned fixed line is as good or slightly faster. Machine breakdowns, breaks and order mix are not modelled.

We make no claim about: **Singapore ownership structure** (an anonymous Chagee source says outlets run under one company and one data system, and that the ownership form does not matter here; I-chagee-contact); **delivery profit by channel**; **Chagee's own equipment cost** (not public); **gross margin per cup** (our assumption); **Chagee's current rostering** beyond what an anonymous Chagee source told us